

Pre-class assignment #16

PHY-905-003
Computational Astrophysics and Astrostatistics
Spring 2026

This assignment is due the evening of Wednesday March 11, 2026. Turn in all materials via GitHub Classroom.

Reading/videos:

1. Read this overview of [compiled vs. interpreted languages](#). Note that the article points out that Python can be run in compiled mode (if you've ever seen a `.pyc` file, that's compiled Python code) but this is usually reserved for imported modules.
2. Watch this video [introducing the GIL](#) (Python's Global Interpreter Lock).
3. Read this article explaining [why the GIL is necessary](#).
4. **Optional:** A recent Python Enhancement Proposal (PEP) lays out a road map for removing the GIL! If you're interested, you can read more [here](#). This proposal is slated to be included with Python 3.13, which is currently in the "pre-release" stage.

Your assignment: After you read the information and watch the video above, summarize the key points from them and put any questions that you might have in the accompanying `ANSWERS.md` file

Handing it in: Include your summary and questions in `ANSWERS.md` and commit it!